

SPOTTING THE ERRORS **SET 5****ERRORS OF ARTICLES**

Directions (Q. Nos. 1-30) Which part of the given sentences has an error? In case, there is no error, choose option (d).

1. The road (a)/ to famous monument (b)/ passes through a forest. (c)/ No error (d)
2. Our Housing Society comprises of (a)/ six blocks and (b)/ thirty three flats in an area of about thousand sq. metres. (c)/ No error (d)
3. Now that she is living in her own flat, (a)/ she cleans the windows (b)/ twice a week in the summer and once a week in the winter. (c)/ No error (d)
4. With little imagination and enterprise, (a)/ the tournament could have been transformed (b)/ into a major attraction. (c)/ No error (d)
5. These display (a)/ the (b)/ remarkable variety. (c)/ No error (d)
6. If you have faith in Almighty (a)/ everything will turn out (b)/ to be all right. (c)/ No error (d)
7. According to the Bible (a)/ it is meek and humble (b)/ who shall inherit the Earth. (c)/ No error (d)
8. On my request (a)/ Lalit introduced me to his friend (b)/ who is singer and a scientist. (c)/ No error (d)
9. This town isn't very well known (a)/ and there isn't much to see (b)/ so a few tourists come here. (c)/ No error (d)
10. He took to (a)/ reading Times (b)/ for better knowledge of the facts. (c)/ No error (d)
11. The accelerating pace of life in our metropolitan city (a)/ has had the tremendous effect (b)/ on the culture and life-style of the people. (c)/ No error (d)
12. Both the civilians (a)/ and armymen (b)/ joined the First World War. (c)/ No error (d)
13. The school is (a)/ within hundred yards (b)/ from my house. (c)/ No error (d)
14. The majority of the computer professionals recommends (a)/ that effective measures (b)/ should be taken against software piracy. (c)/ No error (d)
15. The famous Dr. Chandra (a)/ is only dentist (b)/ in our village. (c)/ No error (d)
16. This candidate lacks (a)/ an experience (b)/ otherwise he is well qualified. (c)/ No error (d)
17. The person I met (a)/ in the theatre (b)/ was the playwright himself. (c)/ No error (d)
18. The interviewer asked me (a)/ if I knew that Kalidas was the greater (b)/ than any other poet. (c)/ No error (d)
19. The reason we have not been able to pay income tax (a)/ is due to fact (b)/ that we did not receive pay on time. (c)/ No error (d)
20. Even now when I see the spot (a)/ I am reminded of an unique incident (b)/ that took place several years ago. (c)/ No error (d)
21. My father (a)/was (b)/ an honest and God fearing man. (c)/ No error (d)
22. Gangotri has special significance (a)/ for the devout as it is considered as (b)/ the abode of King Bhagirath who brought the Ganga down to Earth. (c)/ No error (d)
23. The recent study has indicated that there (a)/ is perceptible change in (b)/ the attitudes of the people. (c)/ No error (d)
24. He was fascinated by insects (a)/ and the more he studied their habits (b)/ greater was his fascination. (c)/ No error (d)
25. With little patience (a)/ you will be able to (b)/ cross this hurdle. (c)/ No error (d)
26. My friends insisted (a)/ that I should see the movie (b)/ from beginning to the end. (c)/ No error (d)
27. Both optimists and pessimists contribute to society; (a)/ the optimist invents the aeroplane (b)/ the pessimist parachute. (c)/ No error (d)
28. A friend (a)/ in need is (b)/ the friend indeed. (c)/ No error (d)
29. Amitabh had (a)/ the cameo (b)/ in the movie. (c)/ No error (d)
30. The former cricketer (a)/ donated a huge amount (b)/ in charity. (c)/ No error (d)

> EXPLANATIONS

1. (b) The Article 'the' should be used before 'famous' as the sentence refers to a particular thing i.e. 'a famous monument'.
2. (c) Article 'a' is used before a common noun to suggest the sense of 'one'. Therefore, 'a' would be used before 'thousand sq. metres' to suggest that it refers to one thousand square metres.
3. (c) The season e.g., summer, winter, etc are abstract nouns. So, articles are not used with them. So, we would remove 'the' before 'summer' and 'winter' and change them to 'summers' and 'winters'.
4. (a) 'Little' means 'none or negligible'. Thus, we should use article 'a' before 'little' as 'a little' means 'some'.
5. (b) In the given sentence, 'the' used with 'remarkable' is incorrect. Instead of 'the' we should use the article 'a'.
6. (a) In the given sentence, the article 'the' would come before 'almighty'. This is done because 'almighty' in the given sentence refers to 'God'.
7. (b) The given sentence implies to represent a class of people i.e., 'the meek' and 'the humble'. Therefore, 'the' should be used before the adjectives 'meek' and 'humble'.
8. (c) The article 'a' should precede the word 'singer'.
9. (c) 'A few' means some and 'few' means 'hardly any'. As per the sentence, 'few' should be used instead of 'a few'.
10. (b) In the given sentence, 'Times' is the name of a newspaper. Therefore, it should be written as 'the Times'.
11. (b) The sentence is incorrect as 'the' is used before the adjective 'tremendous'. So, to correct the sentence we would use 'a' instead of 'the' before 'tremendous'.
12. (b) As per the rule, 'the' should come before an adjective which represents a class of people. Therefore, we should add 'the' before 'armymen'.
13. (b) In the given sentence, the article 'a' should come before 'hundred yards' to convey the meaning that the school is within one hundred yards from the house.
14. (a) The verb 'recommends' is used incorrectly. It should be replaced by 'recommend' to make the sentence grammatically correct.
15. (b) The sentence wants to emphasise the fact that Dr. Chandra is the only dentist in the village. So, we would use 'the' before the word 'only' to convey the desired meaning.
16. (b) As per the rule, articles are omitted before abstract nouns used in general sense. In the given sentence, 'experience' is an abstract noun. So, it should not be preceded by 'an'.
17. (d) The sentence is correct.
18. (b) 'The' should be removed before 'greater' to correct the sentence.
19. (b) 'The' should be added before the word 'fact'.
20. (b) 'An' should be replaced by 'a' to make the sentence grammatically correct.
21. (d) No error
22. (a) The article 'a' would come before 'special'.
23. (b) The article 'a' would come before 'perceptible'.
24. (c) The article 'the' would come before the word 'greater'.
25. (a) As 'little' means negligible. So, we would add 'a' before 'little'.
26. (c) Article 'the' would come before the word 'beginning'.
27. (c) 'The' should be added before 'parachute'.
28. (c) 'A' should come in place of 'the' to make the sentence correct.
29. (b) 'The' should be replaced by 'a' to convey the right meaning of the sentence.
30. (d) No error.

ADVERB

An adverb tells more about a verb, an adjective or another adverb.

e.g. - He is running *fast*.

Here 'fast' is the adverb which tells how he is running.

Kinds of Adverb

- 1. Adverb of Time** Answers the question when, for how long or how often a certain thing happens.
e.g. - I shall meet you *tomorrow*.
- We were late by *two hours*.
- The newspaper arrives *daily*.
- 2. Adverb of Place** Answers the question where.
e.g. - I shall meet you *in the market*.
- I shall meet you *there*.
- We were studying *in the institute*.
- 3. Adverb of Manner** Answers the question how.
e.g. - He is sitting *quietly*.
- He is dancing *like Hritik Roshan*.
- 4. Adverb of Frequency** It tells us how often an action takes place.
e.g. - Delhi Police is with you, *always*.
- 5. Adverb of Degree or Quantity** These tell us how much or in what degree or to what extent.
e.g. - We have studied *enough*.
- There is *something* fishy out here.
- There is *little* doubt of his success.

Rules of Adverbs

- 1. So and Too** They should not be used without their co-relatives 'that' and 'to'.
e.g. - He is *so* rich (X)
- He is *so* rich that he can buy anything. (✓)
- He is *too* intelligent (X)
- He is *too* intelligent to pass any exam. (✓)
- 2. Difference between very and much**
 - (a) 'Very' is used in positive degree and 'much' is used in comparative degree.
e.g. - He is *much* intelligent. (X)
- He is *very* intelligent. (✓)
- He is *much* intelligent than his brother. (✓)
 - (b) 'Very' is used with V₁ + ing.
'Much' is used with V₃.
e.g. - The match became ~~much~~ / *very* interesting.
- The crowd became *much* / ~~very~~ interested in the match.
- 3. Some words retain their form when they become adverbs** : Fast, first, next, back, ill, better, best, etc.

- 4. Adverbs ending in -ly form the comparative by adding 'more' and superlative by adding 'most'.**
e.g. - This work is *more beautifully* done than that work.
- The scenery of Kashmir is *most lovely* of all.
- 5. Adverbs of manner, place and time are generally placed after the verb or after the object of the verb.**
e.g. - We visited Kashmir *last year*.
- He is talking *on and on*.
- He is sitting *quietly*.
- 6. MPT RULE** If adverbs of manner, place and time are used in a single sentence, then the sequence followed is that of *MPT*.
e.g. - I read the book *yesterday* meticulously (X) at home.
- I read the book meticulously at home *yesterday*. (✓)
- 7. When an adverb modifies an adjective or another adverb, the adverb comes before it.**
e.g. - Her dress was ready *nearly*. (X)
- Her dress was *nearly ready*. (✓)
- 8. Adverbs of frequency such as always, ever, never, seldom, frequently, etc, are always placed before the verb they modify.**
e.g. - He *sometimes* comes late.
- She *always* looks beautiful.
- 9. 'Enough'** is both an Adjective and an Adverb. As an adverb, it is always placed after the adjective it modifies. As an adjective it is placed before the noun.
e.g. - He is *enough* intelligent. (X)
- He is intelligent *enough* to win the competition. (✓)
- He has *enough* money to spend.
In the last sentence, 'enough' is used as an adjective.
- 10. 'Only' and 'even'** should be placed immediately before the word intended to modify.
e.g. - I worked *only* two sums. (X)
- I *only* worked two sums. (✓)
- 11. An adverb can be placed at the beginning of a sentence, when it is intended to qualify, not any word in particular, but sentence as a whole.**
e.g. - *Fortunately*, he was not present at that time.
- *Interestingly*, the PM went in the metro.
- 12. 'Ever'** is sometimes misused for 'never'. 'Seldom or never' and 'seldom if ever' are both correct, but 'seldom or ever' is incorrect. In the same manner, 'little if anything' is correct, but 'little or anything' is wrong.
e.g. - He *seldom* or *never* passes in the examination with fair means.
- He *seldom if ever* parties.

13. 'Else' should be followed by 'but', and not by 'than'.
e.g. - It is nothing ~~else than~~ / *but* his carelessness which has led to his failure.
- Aishwarya Rai is nothing *else but* a statue of beauty.
14. 'Rather' and 'Fairly' can mean moderately. But 'fairly' is used with favourable adjectives and adverbs while 'rather' is used with unfavourable adjectives and adverbs.
e.g. - She is *fairly* intelligent but my sister is *rather* stupid.
- He did *fairly* well in her exams but his sister did *rather* badly.
- He grew up in *rather* unusual circumstances.
15. 'Rather' can also be used when we are correcting something that we have just said.
e.g. - The process is not a circle but *rather* a spiral.
16. 'Rather' is also used in case of preference—would rather, had rather, rather than are used to express preference.
e.g. - I *would rather* study than sleep.
- I prefer getting up early *rather than* sleeping late.
17. We use 'rather' before verbs that introduce our thoughts and feelings, in order to express our opinion politely, especially when a different opinion has been expressed.
e.g. - I *rather* think that he was telling the truth.
- I *rather* like the decorative effect.
18. Adverb 'as' should be used to introduce predicative of the verbs such as regard, describe, define, treat, view, know.
e.g. - I regard him *as* my elder brother.
- The newspapers described the situation *as* horrible.
- Biology is defined *as* the study of nature.
19. Adverb 'as' should not be used to introduce predicative of the verbs such as name, elect, think, consider, call, appoint, make, choose.
e.g. - He was *considered* the best dancer of his time.
- He was *appointed* Governor by the President.
- Saurav Ganguly was *chosen* the captain.
- He was called *dynamic* by his mates.
20. Negative Adverbs should not be used with the words that are already negative in sense. So two negatives in the same sentence should be avoided. Seldom, nowhere, never, nothing, hardly, scarcely, neither, barely, rarely are some of the Adverbs. The verbs in such category are 'deny', 'forbid', while the conjunctions are 'unless', 'until', 'lest' and 'both'.
e.g. - *No one scarcely* practises all the exercises. (X)
- *Scarcely anyone* practises all the exercises. (✓)
- I *rarely* went to meet ~~nobody~~ / *anybody* in my childhood.
- She *hardly* knows *anything* / ~~nothing~~ about me.
- He does *nothing* without *ever* / ~~never~~ consulting me.
- He has denied that he was ~~not~~ going there.
- Walk steadily, lest you should ~~not~~ fall.
- Both of them are not coming. (X)
- Neither of them is coming. (✓)
21. Consider the following cases
- (a) 'Coward', 'miser', 'niggard', 'rogue' are Nouns. 'Cowardly', 'miserly', 'niggardly', 'roguish' are Adjectives.
e.g. - An officer is trained never to fight ~~cowardly~~ / *in a cowardly manner*.
- Although he seems brave, he is actually a *coward*.
- It was a sheer *cowardly* act of violence.
- (b) 'Fast' retains its form in both Adjective and Adverb.
e.g. - He is *fast* (Adjective).
- He is running *fast* (Adverb).
- (c) 'Direct' and 'Directly' are adverbs. Direct means *straight* and Directly means *at once*.
e.g. - Don't stop anywhere, return home *direct*.
- Don't stop now, return home *directly*.
- (d) 'Manly', 'masterly', 'slovenly', 'monthly', 'weekly', 'sickly', 'friendly' are Adjectives and should not be confused with Adverbs.
e.g. - He is earning fifty thousand rupees ~~monthly~~ / *a month*.
- He is a *friendly* old man.
22. The use of 'never' for 'not' is incorrect, because 'never' means *not ever*.
e.g. - I *never* remember having met him. (X)
- I do *not* remember ever having met him. (✓)
- We met the other day, but he *never* referred to the matter. (X)
- We met the other day, but he did *not* refer to the matter. (✓)
23. No sentence should begin with 'Due to'. It must be used after some form of the verb 'to be'.
e.g. - *Due to* bad weather, the match was abandoned. (X)
- It was *due to* bad weather, the match was abandoned. (✓)
24. Cent-per cent It should be hundred per cent.
25. Do the needful It should be do what is necessary.

SPOTTING THE ERRORS **SET 6****ERRORS OF ADVERB**

Directions (Q. Nos. 1-30) Which part of the given sentences has an error? In case, there is no error, choose option (d).

1. Firstly, you should think (a)/ over the meaning of the words (b)/ and then use them. (c)/ No error (d)
2. The driver tried his best (a)/ to avert the accident by bringing the car (b)/ to a suddenly stop. (c)/No error (d)
3. The Sunshine hotel was fully equipped (a)/ to offer leisure stay (b)/ to its clients. (c)/ No error (d)
4. The technician reminded them (a)/ to have a thoroughly cleaning (b)/ of the machine after each use. (c)/ No error (d)
5. I am (a)/ much glad (b)/ that you have won the trophy. (c)/ No error (d)
6. He is too coward (a)/ to make it (b)/ happen. (c)/ No error (d)
7. People invent new machines (a)/ when they think (b)/ different. (c)/ No error (d)
8. A man entered the tavern (a)/ and asked for some bread and cheese (b)/ with a decided foreign accent. (c)/ No error (d)
9. Watch how careful (a)/ the sparrow knits the straws (b)/ into one another to form a nest. (c)/ No error (d)
10. On hearing the news (a)/ he went directly (b)/ to the Manager's room. (c)/ No error (d)
11. They reached home (a)/ safely (b)/ although they started late. (c)/ No error (d)
12. It is the duty of every citizen (a)/ to do his utmost to defend (b)/ the hardly won freedom of the country. (c)/ No error (d)
13. The principal was (a)/ enough kind to (b)/ grant me scholarship. (c)/ No error (d)
14. It is nothing else (a)/ than foolishness (b)/ that led to his downfall. (c)/ No error (d)
15. The tried travellers were bundled off (a)/ to the nearby cop house till anyone (b)/ could come and vouch for their credentials. (c)/ No error (d)
16. I advised my brother to engage two coolies instead of one (a)/ because the luggage was too much heavy (b)/ for a single coolie to handle. (c)/ No error (d)
17. There is no one else (a)/ whom I esteem (b)/ than your father. (c)/ No error (d)
18. Although I was (a)/ in Delhi last month (b)/ I never met him. (c)/ No error (d)
19. When I got (a)/ home I was (b)/ too exhausted. (c)/ No error (d)
20. I did not know hardly (a)/ anyone in the city (b)/ and so I felt lonely. (c)/ No error (d)
21. My mother works (a)/ very quicker than (b)/ I at embroidery. (c)/ No error (d)
22. She is sure a great singer (a)/ and no other singer (b)/ is a match for her. (c)/ No error (d)
23. It is better to be frugal (a)/ but don't be miser (b)/ in giving alms. (c)/ No error (d)
24. I refused to (a)/ accompany him because (b)/ I was so tired. (c)/ No error (d)
25. The student came to the classroom (a)/ lately and was punished (b)/ by the teacher. (c)/ No error (d)
26. He looks full of energy (a)/ today because he (b)/ soundly slept last night. (c)/ No error (d)
27. She had barely nothing (a)/ to eat when she came (b)/ to me last month. (c)/ No error (d)
28. It had been too cold (a)/ the whole month and we preferred (b)/ to stay in the plains. (c)/ No error (d)
29. The quickly brown fox (a)/ jumped over (b)/ the lazy dog. (c)/ No error (d)
30. He slowly (a)/ went to open (b)/ the lock. (c)/ No error (d)